

# Canesten®

# GYN

## 6 Day Therapy



### Broad-Spectrum Antifungal Vaginal Tablets

#### Active ingredient

1 vaginal tablet contains:

Clotrimazole.....0.1g

#### Product Description

Biconvex white-pale yellow pessary with 1 rounded end. One side has "BAYER" while the reverse has "P3".

#### Pharmacodynamic

Clotrimazole, the active ingredient of Canesten® is an imidazole derivative with a broad spectrum of antimycotic activity.

#### Mechanism of action

Clotrimazole acts against fungi by inhibiting ergosterol synthesis. Inhibition of ergosterol synthesis leads to structural and functional impairment of the fungal cytoplasmic membrane. Clotrimazole has a broad antimycotic spectrum of action in vitro and in vivo, which includes dermatophytes, yeasts, moulds, etc.

Under appropriate test conditions, the MIC values for these types of fungi are in the region of less than 0.062-8.0 µg/ml substrate.

The mode of action of clotrimazole is primarily fungistatic or fungicidal depending on the concentration of clotrimazole at the site of infection. In-vitro activity is limited to proliferating fungal elements; fungal spores are only slightly sensitive. In addition to its antimycotic action, clotrimazole also acts on gram-positive microorganisms (Streptococci / Staphylococci / Gardnerella vaginalis), and gram-negative microorganisms (Bacteroides).

In vitro clotrimazole inhibits the multiplication of Corynebacteria and grampositive cocci - with the exception of Enterococci - in concentrations of 0.5-10 µg/ml substrate. Primarily resistant variants of sensitive fungal species are very rare; the development of secondary resistance by sensitive fungi has so far only been observed in very isolated cases under therapeutic conditions.

#### Pharmacokinetics

Pharmacokinetic investigations after vaginal application have shown that only a small amount of clotrimazole (3-10%) is absorbed. Due to the rapid hepatic metabolism of absorbed clotrimazole into pharmacologically inactive metabolites the resulting peak plasma concentrations of clotrimazole after vaginal application of a 500 mg dose were less than 10 ng/ml, suggesting that clotrimazole applied

intravaginally is unlikely to lead to measurable systemic effects or side effects.

#### Preclinical safety data

Non-clinical data reveal no special hazard for humans based on conventional studies of safety pharmacology, repeated dose toxicity, genotoxicity, carcinogenic potential and toxicity to reproduction and development.

#### Indications

Infections of the genital region (vaginitis) caused by fungi (usually Candida) and superinfections caused by Clotrimazole-sensitive bacteria.

#### Dosage and application

1 vaginal tablet to be introduced each evening on 6 successive days. Alternatively, 2 vaginal tablets may be inserted into the vagina at bedtime for 3 consecutive nights. The vaginal tablet should be inserted as deeply as possible into the vagina in the evening before going to bed. Insertion is best achieved when lying back with the legs slightly drawn up.

Clotrimazole vaginal tablets need moisture in the vagina to dissolve completely, otherwise undissolved pieces of the vaginal tablet might crumble out of the vagina. To prevent this it is important to insert the medication as deeply as possible into the vagina at bedtime. Should the vaginal tablet not dissolve completely within one night the use of a vaginal cream should be considered.

If symptoms persist for more than 7 days the patient may have a medical condition that requires treatment by a doctor.

The treatment can be repeated if necessary, however, recurrent infections may indicate an underlying medical cause. Patient should seek medical advice if symptoms return within 2 months.

If the labia and adjacent areas are simultaneously infected, local treatment with an external cream should also be given in addition to the intravaginal treatment (combination treatment). The sexual partner should also undergo local treatment if symptoms, e.g. pruritus, inflammation, etc. are present.

Treatment during the menstrual period should not be performed. The treatment should be finished before the onset of menstruation.

Do not use tampons, intravaginal douches, spermicides or other vaginal products while using this product.

Avoidance of vaginal intercourse is recommended in case of vaginal infection and while using this product the partner could become infected.

During pregnancy, the vaginal tablets should be used and should be inserted without using an applicator.

Not for use in children under 16.

### **Pregnancy**

Experimental and clinical investigations give no indication that Canesten® has any harmful effects on the mother and child when administered during pregnancy. Sanitation of the birth canal should be ensured particularly during the last 4-6 weeks of pregnancy.

During pregnancy the Canesten® vaginal tablet should be inserted without using an applicator. Administration during the first trimester of pregnancy should be used with clear indication.

### **Lactation**

Available pharmacodynamic/toxicological data in animals have shown excretion of clotrimazole/ metabolites in milk. Breast-feeding should be discontinued during treatment with clotrimazole.

### **Contraindications**

Hypersensitivity to clotrimazole or to any other component of the product.

### **Special Warning and Special Precautions for Use**

If the patient has a fever (temperature of 38°C or above), lower abdominal pain, back pain, foul smelling vaginal discharge, nausea, vaginal haemorrhage, and/or associated shoulder pain the patient should consult a doctor.

Keep medicine out of the reach of children. Avoid contact with eyes. Do not swallow.

### **Drug interaction**

Concomitant medication with vaginal clotrimazole and oral tacrolimus (FK-506; immunosuppressant) might lead to increased tacrolimus plasma levels and similarly with sirolimus.

Patients should be thoroughly monitored for symptoms of tacrolimus or sirolimus overdose, if necessary by determination of the respective plasma levels.

### **Adverse effects**

Immune system disorders: allergic reaction (syncope, hypotension, dyspnea, urticaria)

Reproductive system and breast disorders: genital peeling, pruritis, rash, edema, erythema, discomfort, burning, irritation, pelvic pain & vaginal haemorrhage.

Gastrointestinal disorders: abdominal pain.

### **Overdosage**

No risk of acute intoxication is seen as it is unlikely to occur following a single vaginal application of an overdose. There is no specific antidote.

### **Storage**

Do not store above 30°C

### **Presentation**

Pack containing 6 vaginal tablets of 0.1g, each sealed in aluminium foil with applicator.

Manufactured by

Bayer AG

51368 Leverkusen

Germany

Product Registration Holder

Bayer Co. (Malaysia) Sdn. Bhd.

25-03 & 25-04, Level 25, IMAZIUM,

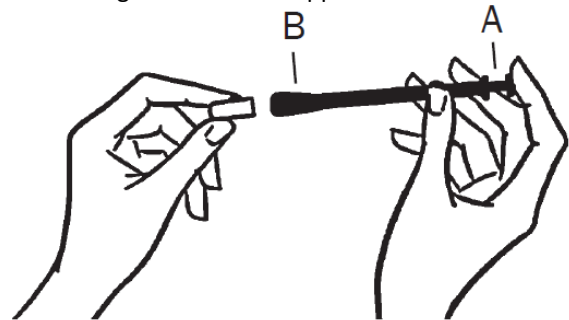
No. 8, Jalan SS21/37, Damansara Uptown,  
47400 Petaling Jaya, Selangor.

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### **Directions for using the applicator**

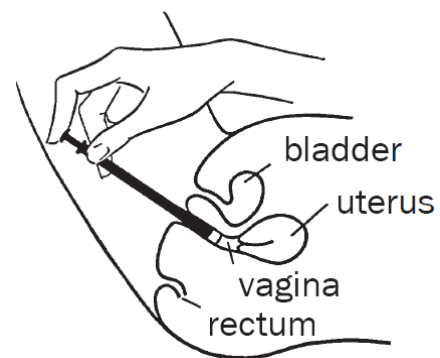
1. Pull of plunger A until it stops

Place a vaginal tablet into applicator B



2. Carefully insert the applicator containing the tablet as deeply as possible into the vaginal. This is best achieved when lying on your back.

3. Push plunger A carefully until it stops, thereby depositing the tablet into the vagina. Remove the applicator.



### **Note**

Pregnant women should strictly follow the instruction of their doctor.

On doctor's prescription only